

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

The Client Scope & Protection Playbook

Stop the chaos. Set the rules. Get paid — every time.

A complete system for freelancers & small service businesses
to on-board clients, lock in boundaries, and protect their work and income.

Modules 1–6 · Scripts, Checklists & Progress Trackers Included

How to Use This Playbook

This SOP is built for people who are great at their craft but tired of being burned by unclear client expectations, revision loops that never end, and invoices that don't get paid. You don't need any prior business experience. Every module is self-contained — read it, apply it, and tick the boxes as you go.

☐ Read	Each module covers one specific part of the client relationship. Read it fully before applying.
☒ Checklists	Use the checklist at the end of each module before moving to the next client step.
☐ Track	Fill in your Progress Tracker score honestly — it shows exactly where you're strong and where to improve.
☐ Scripts	Copy the scripts word-for-word, then personalise with your name and service type.
☐ Repeat	Re-use this system for every single client — consistency is where the protection comes from.

What You Will Have After This Playbook

- A professional client intake process that sets expectations from Day 1
- A clear, written scope that makes 'but I thought that was included' impossible
- A revision policy that stops endless back-and-forth for free
- Payment terms that actually get followed — with scripts for chasing late invoices
- A clean offboarding process that ends every project on your terms
- A personal scorecard so you can see your improvement over time

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MODULE

1

The Client Intake Process

What to do before you ever say yes — and before they pay a penny.

WHY THIS MODULE EXISTS

Why This Module Exists

Most freelancers skip intake. They get an enquiry, they reply, they start work. Then three weeks in, the client says 'I thought this included X' and suddenly you're doing extra work for free — or having an uncomfortable conversation you weren't prepared for. This module fixes that. A solid intake process filters out bad-fit clients early, sets the tone for the entire relationship, and gives you information you need to price and scope accurately.

☐ New to business?

Think of intake like a job interview — except YOU are interviewing THEM. You're deciding if this client is someone you want to work with, not just if they'll hire you.

STEP 1

Step 1 — The Initial Response (Within 24 Hours)

When an enquiry comes in, don't panic and agree to everything on the first message. Send a short, professional response that acknowledges them and moves them into your intake flow.

EMAIL SCRIPT: First Response to a New Enquiry

Subject: Re: [Their subject line]

Hi [Name],

Thank you for reaching out! I'd love to learn more about your project.

To make sure I can give you an accurate quote and timeline, I've put together a few short questions — it takes about 3 minutes to complete.

[Link to intake form / or paste questions below]

Once I have your answers, I'll get back to you within [48 hours / 2 business days] with next steps.

Looking forward to it,
[Your Name]

STEP 2

Step 2 — The Intake Form (The 8 Questions You Must Ask)

You can use a free Google Form, Typeform, or even a simple email. The goal is to get this information BEFORE your discovery call — so you don't waste an hour on a call only to find out they have a £50 budget.

Q1: What is the project?	Ask them to describe it in 2–3 sentences in their own words.
Q2: What is the deadline?	Hard deadline or flexible? This affects your pricing.
Q3: What is your approximate budget?	Give them ranges, e.g. Under £500 / £500–£1,500 / £1,500+
Q4: Have you worked with a professional like me before?	First-timers need more hand-holding — factor this into your time.

Q5: What does success look like to you?	This reveals their real goals vs. their stated goals.
Q6: Who will be the main point of contact?	Multiple decision-makers = revision hell. Know this early.
Q7: How do you prefer to communicate?	Email only vs. WhatsApp vs. calls — set this before you start.
Q8: Is there anything that would stop this project going ahead?	Surfaces objections early so you're not surprised later.

STEP 3

Step 3 — The Discovery Call (30 Minutes, No More)

If the intake form looks promising, book a 30-minute discovery call. Not an hour. Thirty minutes. This keeps it professional and stops you from giving away free consulting time. Use this agenda:

0–5 min	Warm up — ask about them, their business, current situation
5–15 min	Dig into the project — what they need, why now, what's been tried
15–22 min	Share your process briefly — how you work, timeline, what you need from them
22–28 min	Address any questions they have
28–30 min	Confirm next steps — 'I'll send a proposal by [date]'

❑ **Red Flags — Consider Walking Away If...**

They refuse to give any budget range ('just give me your lowest price')

They say 'it should be simple' before you've even quoted

They've 'had bad experiences with every other professional' they've hired

They want work to start before any agreement is signed

They can't tell you who the final decision-maker is

STEP 4

Step 4 — The Follow-Up (Within 24 Hours of the Call)

✂ **EMAIL SCRIPT: Post-Discovery Call Follow-Up**

Subject: Great speaking with you — next steps

Hi [Name],

Great speaking with you today. Based on our conversation, I'll be putting together a detailed proposal for [project summary] and will send it over by [specific date and time].

If anything changes on your end in the meantime, please do let me know.

Talk soon,

[Your Name]

COMPLETION CHECKLIST

Module 1 — Completion Checklist

☐	Initial enquiry responded to within 24 hours
☐	Intake form sent and completed by client
☐	Budget and deadline confirmed before booking a call
☐	Discovery call held (30 minutes max)
☐	Red flags reviewed — decision made to proceed or decline
☐	Post-call follow-up sent with proposal date confirmed

PROGRESS TRACKER

Module 1 — Progress Tracker

Rate yourself after every client using this module. Be honest — the score only helps you if it's real.

Skill Area	What to Measure	My Score (1–10)
Enquiry Response Speed	Am I replying within 24 hours consistently?	___ / 10
Intake Form Usage	Did I send the form before the call?	___ / 10
Red Flag Detection	Did I identify any concerns before starting?	___ / 10
Call Structure	Did I stick to 30 minutes?	___ / 10

☐ **What will I change about my intake process after this module?**

MODULE

2

Writing a Scope of Work That Protects You

The most important document in your business — and most people skip it entirely.

WHY THIS MODULE EXISTS

Why This Module Exists

A Scope of Work (SOW) is a simple written document that says: here's exactly what I'm doing, here's what I'm NOT doing, and here's what it costs. It is the single most powerful tool you have to protect yourself against scope creep — when a client adds more and more to the project without agreeing to pay more. No SOW = no protection.

☐ New to business?

'Scope creep' is when small additions pile up — 'can you just also...' said ten times is suddenly twice the work for the same price. A written scope stops this before it starts.

THE 7 ESSENTIAL PARTS

The 7 Essential Parts of Every Scope of Work

1. Project Overview	2–3 sentences describing the project in plain language.
2. Deliverables — What IS Included	A specific list — not general, not vague. '5 Instagram posts' not 'social media content'.
3. Exclusions — What is NOT Included	Explicitly name what you're not doing. This is your force field against 'I thought that was included'.

4. Timeline & Milestones	Delivery dates for each stage. Both sides know what to expect and when.
5. Client Responsibilities	What the client must provide and by when. Delays on their side don't pause your clock.
6. Revision Policy	How many rounds of changes are included (covered in full in Module 3).
7. Investment (Price)	Total fee, payment schedule, and what happens if scope changes.

FULL TEMPLATE

Full Scope of Work Template

Copy this. Fill in the [brackets]. Send it before any work begins.

SCOPE OF WORK TEMPLATE

SCOPE OF WORK

=====

Client: [Client Full Name / Business Name]

Service Provider: [Your Name / Business Name]

Date: [Date]

Project: [Project Title]

1. PROJECT OVERVIEW

[2-3 sentences describing what the project is and what you've been hired to achieve]

2. DELIVERABLES — WHAT IS INCLUDED

- [Specific deliverable 1]
- [Specific deliverable 2]
- [Specific deliverable 3]

3. EXCLUSIONS — WHAT IS NOT INCLUDED

The following are NOT included and will be quoted separately if required:

- [Exclusion 1]
- [Exclusion 2]
- [Exclusion 3]

4. TIMELINE

- [Milestone 1]: [Date]
- [Milestone 2]: [Date]
- Final delivery: [Date]

5. CLIENT RESPONSIBILITIES

For this project to proceed on schedule, the client agrees to provide:

- [Materials / info needed]
- Feedback within [X] business days of each submission
- A single point of contact for all approvals

6. REVISION POLICY

This project includes [X] rounds of revisions. Additional rounds are charged at [your hourly rate] per hour.

7. INVESTMENT

Total fee: [Amount]

Deposit (due before work begins): [Amount or %]

Balance due: [On delivery / on [date]]

Scope changes will be quoted separately in writing before any additional work begins.

SIGNATURES

Client signature: _____ Date: _____

Your signature: _____ Date: _____

✦✦ Pro Tip on Exclusions

Be explicit. If you're a web designer, write: 'Does not include copywriting, stock image licensing, SEO setup, or ongoing maintenance.' Every line you add here is a conversation you won't have to have later.

COMPLETION CHECKLIST**Module 2 — Completion Checklist**

☐	All deliverables are specific and measurable (not vague)
☐	Exclusions section is complete
☐	Client responsibilities clearly listed with deadlines
☐	Revision limit is stated
☐	Payment schedule is clear
☐	SOW sent to client before any work begins
☐	Client has signed or confirmed acceptance in writing

PROGRESS TRACKER

Module 2 — Progress Tracker

Skill Area	What to Measure	My Score (1–10)
SOW Sent Before Work	Did I send the SOW before lifting a finger?	___ / 10
Specificity of Deliverables	Are all items measurable and clear?	___ / 10
Exclusions Written	Did I list what's NOT included?	___ / 10
Client Signed / Confirmed	Do I have written acceptance?	___ / 10

☐ What will I improve in my SOW process?

MODULE

3

Revision Policy — Ending the Endless Loop

The script for when 'just one more small thing' has turned into a full redo.

WHY THIS MODULE EXISTS

Why This Module Exists

The most upvoted post in the r/freelance community (89,000+ people agreed with it) was titled: 'Client wants 47 revisions and refuses to pay.' The comments were full of freelancers who felt exactly the same. This module gives you the system to make that situation structurally impossible before it ever starts.

HOW MANY TO INCLUDE

How Many Revisions Should You Include?

One round	Small, quick projects. E.g., a single graphic, a short piece of copy.
Two rounds	Standard for most projects. First draft → client feedback → revision → final.
Three rounds	Complex or high-value projects where decisions involve multiple stakeholders.
Unlimited	☐ NEVER offer this. It has no boundary and will be exploited.

DEFINING A ROUND

Defining What a 'Round of Revisions' Actually Means

A 'round' is one consolidated set of feedback, submitted at one time — not five separate emails over three days. Make this explicit in your SOW:

✂️ ADD THIS CLAUSE TO YOUR SOW

A revision round is defined as one consolidated set of feedback submitted in a single document or message. Multiple separate feedback messages will be counted as separate revision rounds. Please compile all feedback before submitting.

THE 3 SCENARIOS

The 3 Revision Scenarios — And What to Say

Scenario A — Client Sends Feedback in Pieces (Drip-Feeding)

✂️ EMAIL SCRIPT: Drip-Feed Feedback

Subject: Re: [Project name] feedback

Hi [Name],

Thank you for your notes on [item]. Just a quick heads-up — as per our agreement, revisions work best when all feedback is compiled and sent together. This helps me action everything at once and keeps us on schedule.

Could you gather any remaining notes and send them all in one message?
I'll get started as soon as I have the full list.

Thanks for understanding!
[Your Name]

Scenario B — Client Has Used Up Their Included Revisions

✂ EMAIL SCRIPT: Revision Limit Reached

Subject: Re: [Project name] — further revisions

Hi [Name],

I've completed the [X] rounds of revisions included in our scope.
The current version reflects all the changes we've discussed so far.

I'm happy to continue making adjustments — any further revisions will be billed at [your rate] per hour / [flat fee per round], and I'll send a quick invoice before proceeding.

Just let me know how you'd like to move forward!
[Your Name]

Scenario C — Client Wants to Change Direction Entirely

□ Important Distinction

A revision is a small change to an existing direction. A change of direction is a new project. If a client has approved a concept and now wants something completely different, that is a scope change — not a revision — and should be quoted separately.

EMAIL SCRIPT: Direction Change (Scope Change)

Subject: Re: [Project name] – new direction

Hi [Name],

Thank you for your thoughts – I can see you're looking for something quite different from what we'd initially agreed.

What you're describing is a new direction rather than a revision to the existing work. I'm absolutely able to take the project this way.

I'll put together a short change-of-scope note with a revised quote and timeline for your review. Sound good?

[Your Name]

COMPLETION CHECKLIST

Module 3 — Completion Checklist

☐	Revision limit clearly stated in SOW (a specific number)
☐	Definition of 'a round' included in SOW
☐	Rate for additional revisions stated in SOW
☐	I know the difference between a revision and a scope change
☐	I have all three scripts saved and ready to use

PROGRESS TRACKER

Module 3 — Progress Tracker

Skill Area	What to Measure	My Score (1–10)
Revision Limit Set	Did I specify a number before work started?	___ / 10
Definition Clarity	Does the client understand what one 'round' means?	___ / 10
Handling Extras Calmly	Did I stay professional when the limit was hit?	___ / 10
Scope vs. Revision	Did I correctly identify scope changes?	___ / 10

☐ Which scenario have I faced, and how did it go?

MODULE

4

Payment Terms & Late Invoice Scripts

How to get paid — and what to say when you're not.

WHY THIS MODULE EXISTS

Why This Module Exists

Late payments are not just a cash flow problem — they're a confidence problem. Most people don't follow up because they feel awkward, so invoices sit unpaid. This module removes the awkwardness by giving you a word-for-word system.

PAYMENT STRUCTURE

The Payment Structure That Protects You

Project under £/\$/€500	50% deposit upfront. 50% on delivery.
Project £500–£2,000	50% deposit upfront. 50% on delivery — or milestone-based.
Project over £2,000	33% upfront, 33% at midpoint, 33% on delivery.
Ongoing monthly retainer	Invoice on the 1st. Due by the 15th. Work pauses if unpaid.

✦ Rule to Live By

Never begin work without a deposit. A client who won't pay upfront won't pay at the end either.

INVOICE CHECKLIST

What to Include in Every Invoice

☐	Your name / business name and contact details
☐	Client name and business name
☐	Unique invoice number (keeps your records clean)
☐	Issue date and due date (e.g., 'Net 14' means due 14 days from issue)
☐	Itemised list of services
☐	Total amount due (with tax if applicable)
☐	Your payment details (bank transfer, PayPal, Stripe, etc.)
☐	Late payment clause (e.g., 'Overdue invoices accrue 2% interest per month')

4 ESCALATING SCRIPTS

The Late Payment Sequence — 4 Escalating Scripts

Use these in order. Don't skip ahead — the sequence is designed to be firm without burning the relationship. Most invoices are paid by Script 2.

 SCRIPT 1: Day After Due Date — Friendly Reminder

Subject: Invoice #[XXX] — Quick reminder

Hi [Name],

Just a quick note to flag that Invoice #[XXX] for [Amount] was due on [Date]. If payment has already been sent, please disregard this.

If not, please do let me know if you have any questions about the invoice.

Payment details: [your bank / PayPal / Stripe link]

Thank you,
[Your Name]

 SCRIPT 2: 7 Days Overdue — Firmer Follow-Up

Subject: Invoice #[XXX] — 7 days overdue

Hi [Name],

I'm following up again on Invoice #[XXX] for [Amount], which was due on [Date] and is now 7 days overdue.

Could you please confirm when payment will be made? If there's an issue with the invoice or payment process, I'm happy to help sort it out.

Thank you for your prompt attention to this.
[Your Name]

 SCRIPT 3: 14 Days Overdue — Formal Notice

Subject: Invoice #[XXX] — Formal overdue notice

Dear [Name],

This is a formal notice that Invoice #[XXX] for [Amount] remains unpaid, [X] days after the due date of [Date].

Please arrange payment within the next 5 business days. As noted in our agreement, overdue invoices are subject to a late payment fee.

If payment is not received by [specific date], I will need to pause any ongoing work until the account is settled.

Please contact me if you wish to discuss this.

[Your Name]

✂ SCRIPT 4: 30+ Days — Final Notice Before Action

Subject: Final notice — Invoice #[XXX]

Dear [Name],

Despite several reminders, Invoice #[XXX] for [Amount] dated [Date] remains unpaid. This is a final notice before I take formal action to recover the debt.

If full payment is not received by [Date — 7 days from today], I will pursue this matter through [small claims court / a debt recovery agency].

I would prefer to resolve this professionally. Please contact me immediately.

[Your Full Name]

[Your Business Name]

□ Practical Note on Disputes

In the UK, claims under £10,000 can be filed through small claims court (gov.uk/make-court-claim). In the US, limits vary by state. In Australia, VCAT/NCAT handle small claims. These processes exist — knowing this makes Script 4 feel much more confident to send.

PROGRESS TRACKER

Module 4 — Progress Tracker

Skill Area	What to Measure	My Score (1–10)
Deposit Policy	Do I always take a deposit before starting?	___ / 10
Invoice Completeness	Do all invoices have a due date and late fee clause?	___ / 10
Follow-Up Speed	Do I follow up the day after the due date?	___ / 10
Script Usage	Have I saved the scripts and used them?	___ / 10

☐ What is my biggest payment challenge right now?

MODULE

5

Mid-Project Check-In System

A short pulse-check that prevents big surprises at the finish line.

WHY THIS MODULE EXISTS

Why This Module Exists

Most project problems don't appear at the end — they were there in the middle and nobody said anything. A structured mid-project check-in takes 10 minutes and can save you days of rework. It also makes clients feel looked after, which means better reviews and more referrals.

WHEN TO RUN IT

When to Run the Check-In

Short projects (under 2 weeks)	One check-in at the halfway point
Medium projects (2–6 weeks)	One check-in at 2 weeks and one at 4 weeks
Long projects (6+ weeks)	Fortnightly check-ins as standard

THE 4 QUESTIONS

The Check-In Has 4 Questions — No More

Q1	Is everything progressing as you expected?
Q2	Is there anything you've seen that you'd like to adjust going forward?
Q3	Are there any materials or decisions I'm still waiting on from your side?

Q4	Is there anything you're unclear about in what's been delivered so far?
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EMAIL SCRIPT: Mid-Project Check-In

Subject: [Project name] – quick halfway check-in

Hi [Name],

We're at the halfway point of [project name], so I wanted to check in.

A few quick questions:

1. Is everything progressing as you expected?
2. Is there anything you've seen so far you'd like to adjust going forward?
3. Are there any materials or decisions I'm still waiting on from your side?
4. Is there anything you're unclear about?

We're on track for [next milestone] on [date]. Looking forward to your thoughts.

[Your Name]

WHAT TO DO WITH THE ANSWERS

What to Do With the Answers

- If everything is fine — great, log it and move on.
- If they mention something unexpected — thank them, document it, and decide: is it within scope (fix it) or outside scope (quote it separately)?
- If they're waiting on something from you — set a deadline and stick to it.
- If they're waiting on something from THEM — this is your paper trail if the project runs late.

✦ Document Everything

Reply to check-in emails with a brief summary: 'Thanks — just to confirm, [X] is outstanding from your side, due by [date]. Once received, I'll complete [Y] by [date].' This creates a paper trail that protects you if timelines slip.

COMPLETION CHECKLIST**Module 5 — Completion Checklist**

☐	Check-in scheduled at project start (not ad-hoc)
☐	Check-in sent on time
☐	All 4 questions asked
☐	Any issues documented in writing
☐	Outstanding client items noted with deadline
☐	Next milestone confirmed after check-in

PROGRESS TRACKER

Module 5 — Progress Tracker

Skill Area	What to Measure	My Score (1–10)
Check-In Timing	Did I schedule the check-in at project start?	___ / 10
Issue Detection	Did the check-in surface anything I needed to know?	___ / 10
Paper Trail	Did I document outstanding items in writing?	___ / 10
Client Feeling	Did the client seem reassured by the check-in?	___ / 10

☐ What did the check-in reveal on my last project?

MODULE

6

Clean Offboarding — Ending Well

How you end a project determines whether you get rehired or referred.

WHY THIS MODULE EXISTS

Why This Module Exists

Most freelancers finish a project and disappear. The client receives their files, pays (hopefully), and that's it. This is a missed opportunity. A clean offboarding process ties up loose ends, creates an experience clients remember, and generates referrals and reviews on autopilot.

THE 5-STEP SEQUENCE

The 5-Step Offboarding Sequence

Step 1: Delivery Message	Send the final deliverables with a clear 'this is the final version' note.
Step 2: Approval Confirmation	Get written sign-off from the client that they're happy with the work.
Step 3: Final Invoice	Send the final invoice at the same time as delivery (not after).
Step 4: Handover Pack	Provide any login details, files, or documentation the client needs.
Step 5: Review Request	Ask for a testimonial or review — most clients say yes if you ask immediately.

 EMAIL SCRIPT: Final Project Delivery

Subject: [Project name] – Final delivery

Hi [Name],

Your project is complete! Attached / linked below you'll find:

- [Final file 1]
- [Final file 2]
- [Any supporting documents / handover notes]

This is the final version as per our agreed scope. Could you please confirm receipt and let me know if everything looks good?

I've also attached your final invoice for [Amount], due by [Date].

It's been a pleasure working with you.

[Your Name]

✂ EMAIL SCRIPT: Review & Testimonial Request (Send 2–3 Days After Delivery)

Subject: A small favour – if you're happy with the work

Hi [Name],

I hope you've had a chance to settle in with everything.

Reviews make a huge difference for small businesses like mine, and I wanted to reach out while our project is still fresh.

If you're happy with the work, would you be willing to leave a short review or testimonial? It only takes 2–3 minutes.

[Link to Google / LinkedIn / Trustpilot / your preferred platform]

Either way, thank you for trusting me with your project.

I hope to work with you again!

[Your Name]

✦ The Offboarding Retention Trick

At the end of the delivery email, add one line: 'I have [1–2 client slots] opening up in [next month] if you're thinking about any upcoming projects.' This simple sentence generates repeat bookings without feeling pushy.

COMPLETION CHECKLIST

Module 6 — Completion Checklist

☐	Final deliverables sent with clear labelling
☐	Written client approval received
☐	Final invoice sent alongside (not after) delivery
☐	Handover pack / files / logins provided
☐	Review request sent 2–3 days after delivery
☐	Project folder archived and labelled
☐	Client added to 'past clients' list for future follow-up

PROGRESS TRACKER

Module 6 — Progress Tracker

Skill Area	What to Measure	My Score (1–10)
Delivery Quality	Was the final package professional and complete?	___ / 10
Approval Confirmed	Did I get written sign-off?	___ / 10
Invoice Timing	Did I send the final invoice with delivery?	___ / 10
Review Requested	Did I ask for a testimonial?	___ / 10

☐ What reaction did I get from the client at offboarding?

B O N U S

Your Master Progress Scorecard

Track your growth across every client project

Rate yourself on each dimension from 1–10 after completing a client project. Fill in three columns over time — your first client, your fifth, and your tenth. Watch the scores improve.

Dimension	Client 1	Client 5	Client 10	Notes
Intake Quality	___ /10	___ /10	___ /10	
Scope Clarity	___ /10	___ /10	___ /10	
Revision Management	___ /10	___ /10	___ /10	
Payment Collection	___ /10	___ /10	___ /10	
Mid-Project Communication	___ /10	___ /10	___ /10	
Offboarding Experience	___ /10	___ /10	___ /10	
Client Satisfaction	___ /10	___ /10	___ /10	
Your Confidence	___ /10	___ /10	___ /10	
Time vs. Budget	___ /10	___ /10	___ /10	
Overall Project Health	___ /10	___ /10	___ /10	
TOTAL SCORE	___ /100	___ /100	___ /100	

What Your Score Means

0 – 40	Starting point. Don't panic — normal for your first few clients. Focus on Modules 1 and 2 first.
41 – 60	Getting there. Some systems but gaps exist. Review which scores are lowest and work on those modules.
61 – 80	Solid foundation. You're protecting yourself most of the time. Keep refining — consistency is the goal.
81 – 100	Professional grade. You run a tight ship. Your job now is to maintain this and help others.

Reflection Questions — Fill These In After Every Project

1. What was the biggest challenge in this project — and which module would have helped?

2. Did I use every script in this playbook? If not, which one and why?

3. Would I work with this client again? What would I do differently next time?

4. What's the ONE thing I'll change about my process before the next client?

Quick Reference — The Complete System at a Glance

Before the Project

- Send intake form → discovery call → proposal → SOW → deposit → start
- Never begin work without a signed scope AND a deposit
- State revision limit and rate in the SOW

During the Project

- Run mid-project check-in on schedule
- Document all client decisions in writing
- Log any scope change requests immediately — quote before acting

At Delivery

- Send final deliverables + final invoice at the same time
- Get written approval from client
- Send review request 2–3 days later

If Things Go Wrong

- Revisions exceeded: use Module 3 Script B
- Direction change: use Module 3 Script C
- Invoice overdue: follow Module 4 sequence in order

You now have everything you need to run your client relationships with confidence.

The scripts are ready. The checklists are ready. All that's left is to use them.

Start with your next enquiry. Run the intake. Send the SOW. Follow the system.

Disclaimer & Legal Notice

Purpose of This Guide

This guide — The Client Scope & Protection Playbook — has been created with the sincere intention of helping new freelancers, independent contractors, and small business owners build more professional, organised, and protected working relationships with their clients. The scripts, templates, checklists, and frameworks included in this document are practical tools designed to reduce operational chaos, minimise the risk of unpaid work, and introduce a greater sense of structure and professionalism into day-to-day business practice.

Every piece of advice in this guide is offered in good faith, drawing on widely recognised best practices within the freelance and small business community. It is our genuine hope that readers will find the material practical, actionable, and valuable as they grow their businesses.

Not Legal or Contractual Advice

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